

The Noble Mahāyāna Sūtra of Limitless Life and Wisdom

Āryāparimitāyurjñānanāmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 849 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཚད་ཡ་ཤེས་དཔག་ཏུ་མཉེན་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་བཞེ་པ་ཆེ་པའི་མཛད།

This text is the Noble Mahāyāna Sūtra on Limitless Life and Wisdom (Sanskrit: Āryāparimitāyurjñāna-nāma-mahāyānasūtra; Tibetan: 'phags pa tshe dang ye shes dpag tu med pa zhes bya ba theg pa chen po'i mdo), catalogued as Toh 849 in the Kangyur. It belongs to the Mahāyāna sūtra class of Buddhist scripture, and opens, as is customary, with homage paid to all buddhas and bodhisattvas. The sūtra centers on the themes of boundless life and boundless wisdom, extolling the extraordinary qualities and liberating power associated with these attributes as embodied by particular buddha figures connected with longevity and transcendent knowledge. As a devotional and doctrinal text, it likely sets forth the benefits of invoking, venerating, or meditating upon limitless life and wisdom, reflecting a widespread current in Mahāyāna literature concerned with longevity practices and the aspiration toward enlightened awareness. Its placement among the Kangyur's sūtra collection marks it as a canonical scripture attributed to the word of the Buddha, valued particularly within traditions emphasizing longevity rites and the cultivation of wisdom.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.